Claes Bäckman

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Artificial intelligence, Financial advice, Housing markets, Household Finance, Mortgage markets, Interest-only mortgages.

CURRENT APPOINTMENTS

2025 – 2027 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie fellow**
Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE

2025 – present **Guest Researcher**
Norges Bank

PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

2024 – 2025 **Interim Professor (W3 Lehrstuhlvertretung)**
Department of Economics, University of Mannheim

2023 – 2024 **Scientific Advisor**
Finansinspektion (Swedish Financial Supervisory Authority)

2023 – 2024 **Advanced Researcher**
Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE

2020 – 2023 **Assistant Professor**
Department of Economics and Business Economics, Aarhus University

2016 – 2019 **Postdoctoral Fellow**
Department of Economics, Lund University, Sweden

EDUCATION

2013 – 2017 **PhD in Economics**, Copenhagen Business School, Denmark.

PUBLICATIONS

1. Mortgage Design, Repayment Schedules, and Household Borrowing (with Patrick Moran and Peter van Santen), *Review of Financial Studies*, Volume 39, Issue 8, August 2026, Pages 2549–2594,
2. Personal Financial Advice and Portfolio Quality (with Olga Balakina, Andreas Hackethal, Tobin Hanspal, & Dominique M. Lammer), *Review of Finance*, Volume 30, Issue 3, May 2026, p. 1029–1069.

3. Beyond Connectivity: Stock Market Participation in a Network (with Olga Balakina & Anastasiia Parakhoniak), *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, Volume 183, February 2026
4. Mortgage Innovation and House Price Booms (with Chandler Lutz), *Journal of Urban Economics*, Volume 145, January 2025
5. Interest-Only Mortgages and Consumption Growth: Evidence from a Mortgage Market Reform (with Natalia Khorunzhina), *International Economic Review*, 65.2: 1049-1079. 2024
6. Participation and Losses in Multi-Level Marketing: Evidence from an FTC Settlement (with Tobin Hanspal), *Financial Planning Review*, 5.1, 2022
7. The Impact of Interest-Only Loans on Affordability (with Chandler Lutz), *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, 2020

ONGOING PROJECTS

1. Mortgage Constraints: Household Responses, Market Adjustment, and Financial Stability (with Ragnar E. Juelsrud and Ella Getz Wold)
   Prepared for the *Journal of Economic Literature*.
2. Housing Capital Gains across the Income Distribution (with Natalia Khorunzhina and Walter D'Lima)
   Selected presentations: EEA 2025, UEA2025, 2025 CEAR-RSI Household Finance Workshop, ReCapNet 2025.
3. One Advisor for the Whole World? Cross-Country Evidence on Financial Advice from Large Language Models
   Funded by Behavioral Finance e.V.
4. Capable but Not Deployable: Institutional Constraints on AI Exposure in Finance, (with Christos Makridis)
   CESifo working paper. Prepared for the AFA call for AI-guided papers.
5. Macroprudential policies and homeownership rates
   Presentations: Bank of England Financial Stability seminar (2026)
6. When Markets Get Confused: Misperception versus Inventory (with Olga Balakina, Arze Karam and Anastasiia Parakhoniak)
   Project supported by the British Academy/Leverhulme Grant SRG1819

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. Monthly Payment Targeting and Borrowing: Experimental Evidence (with Peter van Santen and Andreas Fuster, funded by Behavioral Finance e.V.)
2. Mortgage market design and wealth inequality: Evidence from interest-only mortgages in Denmark (with Danial Ali Akbari, Natalia Khorunzhina and Timo Trimborn).
   Selected presentations: Echoppe Conference on the Economics of Housing and Housing Policies, St Gallen workshop on Macroeconomic Implications of Housing, Household Finances, and Wealth Dynamics, UEA 2023
3. House Prices, Expected Tenure, and Consumption Growth (with Natalia Khorunzhina)
4. Financial Constraints and Homeownership (with Ragnar Juelsrud and Ella Getz Wold)
   Project funded by Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellowship
5. Experimental Evidence on Peer Effects in Finance: Mindful or Mindless Imitation? (with Olga Balakina

and Steve Heinke)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2026 Amorteringskravets effekter på hushållens skuldsättningt. May, 2026. *Ekonomisk Debatt (the Journal of the Swedish Economic Association).*

2019 Hur påverkar amorteringskravet hushållen? Lärdomar från Danmark., 2019. *Ekonomisk Debatt (the Journal of the Swedish Economic Association).*

WORKSHOPS

2026-2027 Practical AI for Academics.

Held at IFN (Stockholm), Aarhus University, Stockholm Business School, KTH (Stockholm), University of Duisburg-Essen, University of Münster, Università della Svizzera italiana, LMU. Planned at Rockwool (Copenhagen), Marburg X4E workshop.

2026 Housing Market Frictions and Access to Homeownership: 1st Annual Workshop in Real Estate Finance, joint with Christian Badarinza (Frankfurt School). August 2026

2019 Main organizer for a workshop on Financial literacy at Lund University, bringing together academics, policymakerss and industry

GRANTS & AWARDS

Combined grant funding: €327.000.

2026 Behavioral Finance e.V. "Language and Country Effects in Financial Advice from LLMs". €6.000, Sole PI.

2026 Behavioral Finance e.V. "Do Mortgage Borrowers Target Monthly Payments? Evidence from a Strategic Survey". €6.000, joint with Peter van Santen.

2024 Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellowship (2025–2027). "Young homeownership (YoHo)". €190.000, sole PI.

2023 Best Lecturer Award (Den Gyldne Pegepind) at the Department of Economics, Aarhus University

2017 – 2020 Tom Hedelius and Jan Wallanders stiftelse. "The long and short term impact of amortization requirements". 1.2 million SEK/ €117.000. Sole PI.

2017 Think Forward Initiative Research Challenge Grantee. "Multi-level Marketing Participation and Social Connectivity". €5.000. Co-PI: Bäckman, Claes & Hanspal, Tobin

2017 Research Center SAFE, Goethe University Frankfurt. "Economic Opportunity and Multi-level Marketing". €3.000. Co-PI: Bäckman, Claes & Hanspal, Tobin

PRESENTATIONS

2026 BI Norwegian Business School, Bank of England, Conference on low-income housing supply and housing affordability, Stockholm Business School, LMU, VfS Annual Conference 2026, 2026 Real Estate and Urban Economics Conference (Università della Svizzera italiana), University of Duisburg-Essen, LMU .

2025 ReCapNet 2025, Goethe University, Riksbanken, Mannheim University (Department of Finance), Mannheim University (Department of Economics).

2024 Mannheim University, Bundesbank, SAFE, Aalto University, VATT Institute for Economic Research, Royal Institute of Technology (Stockholm), ZEW, Mannheim

2023 University of Bergen, Riksbanken, 12th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Bocconi), ECHOPPE 2023 (Toulouse), St Gallen workshop on Macroeconomic implications of housing, household finances and wealth dynamics, 5th ECB/IMF macroprudential policy and research conference (Frankfurt), 15th ReCapNet Conference (Mannheim), NHH Norwegian School of Economics (Bergen), Finansinspektionen (Stockholm)

2022 SGF Conference, EEA-ESEM 2022 x 2, Swedish Economic Conference (Stockholm School of Economics), NFN Young Nordic Scholars

2021 Central Bank of Ireland (Workshop on Borrower finances, financial stability assessment and macroprudential policies); Nationalbanken, Denmark; NFN Young Nordic Scholars Webinar; 15th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association; Finansinspektionen (Swedish Financial Supervisory Authority), Young Scholars Nordic Finance Workshop.

2020 ASSA meetings; Aarhus University; Lund University; EFA 2020; Nordic Junior Macro Seminar Series

2019 European Economic Association Congress 2019; Econometric Society Winter Meetings

2018 Riksbanken; Aarhus University; Swedish National Conference in Economics; Research Institute for Industrial Economics, CEAR-RSI Household Finance Workshop in Montreal

2017 Norges Bank Workshop on Housing and Household Finance, Oslo; 2nd SAFE Household Finance Workshop, Frankfurt;

2016 Riksbanken; International Association for Applied Econometrics Annual Conference, Milano; Copenhagen Business School, Denmark; Lund University, Sweden; Econometric Society Winter Meeting, Edinburgh

2015 Nationalbanken, Denmark; Copenhagen Business School, Denmark, Midwestern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Minneapolis

2014 Danish Graduate Program in Economics Annual Workshop

OUTREACH

2026 Aftonbladet newspaper article about the new macroprudential regulations in Sweden Link

2024 SAFE blog post on "Personal Financial Advice and Portfolio Quality". Link

2024 SAFE blog post on "Mortgage Design, Repayment Schedules, and Household Borrowing". Link

2023 Interviewed for Business Insider on interest-only mortgages. HENRYs are turning to a little-known and risky type of mortgage as home prices soar

2023 Interview on Swedish radio P1, about the Danish mortgage market

2023 Interview with Tobin Hanspal featuring our work on Multilevel Marketing in der Standard, Austria.

2022 Debate article about loans for first-time buyers at Finans.dk, joint with Michael Svarer. Håndsrækning til førstegangskøbere kan øge kløfterne på boligmarkedet

2022 Personal Recommendations and Portfolio Quality: Featured blog post in Duke Financial Economics Center: FinReg Blog

2022 Personal Recommendations and Portfolio Quality. Featured article in FAZ

2021 Launched a financial literacy course for immigrants at www.finanskurse.se (English verion)in collaboration with Finansinspektionen (the Swedish Financial Supervisory Authority). Media coverage: Göteborgsposten

2021 Debate article in Politiken (a major Danish newspaper) about interest-only mortgages in Denmark and the housing market for young households. "De afdragsfrie lån skabte en boligfest, men ikke for unge"

2020 Wrote on Ekonomistas, a popular blog by Swedish economists, about the amortization requirement and Corona. Finansinspektionen måste gå längre och avskaffa amorteringskravet!

2019 Interviewed about the amortization requirement in Sweden on TV4 (major television channel) and several newspaper. Dagens industri, Affärsvärlden, among others

2017 Responded to arguments that economics was an outdated discipline in a major Swedish newspaper, together with Petter Lundborg and Tommy Andersson Forskare: Argumenten är förlegade

2017 Interviewed on Ekonomiekot, Sveriges Radio, about house prices in Denmark and Sweden Boprisrallyt i Norden oroar

REVIEWER

Review of Financial Studies, JPE Macro, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Nordic Economic Policy Review, Scandinavian Journal of Economics, Empirical Economics

TEACHING

University of Mannheim (1 = highest grade)
Credit and Housing markets, Master elective. (Average grade: 1.1/5)
Household Finance x2 , Bachelor elective (Grade: 1.6/5) & Master elective (N/A)

Household Finance Seminar x 2, Bachelor/Master elective (Grade: 1.0/5)

Aarhus University (5 = highest grade)
Macroeconomics, advanced Bachelor-level, Aarhus University
Best Lecturer Award (Den Gyldne Pegepind) at the Department of Economics in 2023.
Average teaching evaluation grade of 4.6/5 in 2022.

Lund University
Macroeconomic Theory and Economic Policy, bachelor-level course in macroeconomics

SUPERVISION

PhD (co-advisor)

2022 – 2024 Alexander Kjær Hilsløv, Aarhus University. Main advisor: Jonas Maibom

Bachelor and Master thesis supervision

2024 – 2025 Three Bachelor and one Master thesis supervised at University of Mannheim

2020 – 2023 Ten Bachelor and three Master theses supervised at Aarhus University

2017 – 2019 Five Bachelor and nine Master theses supervised at Lund University

PERSONAL

Swedish (Native), English (Fluent), Danish (advanced), German (A2 and still learning)
Married, one child (2019, parental leave September 2019 – December 2019), Swedish citizen